PLUG AND PLAY · PAID MEDIA · OCTOBER 2026

Paid media audit

Meta, Google Search and ChatGPT Ads: what is going well, what is going wrong, and the structure we propose

$180,940	$89,478	$257	1 Jan – 13 Oct 2026
Meta	Google Search	ChatGPT Ads test	spend covered

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SUMMARY

The short version

Going well

- **Meta Deep Tech report ads** bring the cheapest leads: $4–$13 CPL in all 7 locations.
- **Meta retargeting** with a press quote: $13 CPL. Europe and the Middle East cost $8–$13 CPM vs $33–$44 in the US.
- **Google corporate searches and copy** convert best: 24% conversion rate in the Innovation ad group.

Going wrong

- **Both platforms optimise to any form fill**, students and job seekers included, not qualified leads.
- **Meta is spread thin**: 9 campaigns, 30 ad sets, 243 ads on $160 a day (about $4 per ad set).
- **Google**: 60% of Search spend lands on the homepage (no form); 37% buys our own brand name.
- **ChatGPT test**: $257, 43 clicks, 0 leads. Homepage, no tracking, US only.

Proposal

1. **Meta**: 4 campaigns, 7 ad sets, 3–5 ads each. Scale Deep Tech and AI, test the rest. Same $160 a day.
2. **Google**: brand in its own campaign, corporate-only ad groups by region, a form behind every ad.
3. **All channels**: optimise to corporate forms now, qualified leads next. ChatGPT Test 2 with a form page.

CPL = cost per lead (Meta results: forms sent on our pages), last 30 days (14 Sep – 13 Oct 2026). CPM: this year. Google and ChatGPT converted from EUR at 1.1177.

META · TODAY

Meta today: 9 campaigns, 30 ad sets, 243 ads on $160 a day

Goal of the lead campaigns: any form sent on our pages (“welcome conversion”), students and job seekers included

9 CAMPAIGNS

7 location campaigns
$10-$26 a day each · $113 in total
US-California · US East Coast · US & Canada · US Middle-South · EMEA · Middle East · Western Europe

1 retargeting campaign
Worldwide · $41 a day

1 traffic campaign
US · $5 a day

30 LIVE AD SETS

→ **Deep Tech** $4-$13 CPL · **AI** $8-$56 · **Brand** up to $140 · **Health** up to $51 · **Innovation Leader** off

Same 4 live topics in every location = 28 ad sets, about $4 a day each

→ **Past sign-ups (180 days)**
$13 CPL · Meta may widen it

→ **1 ad set**
landing-page views

243 LIVE ADS

→ **About 8 ads per ad set**
One quantum video exists as 12+ copies

→ **53 ads in one ad set**
Best this year: press-quote image, $15.66 CPL

→ **Lands on the AI CoE page**
No form

Going well

- **Deep Tech** is the cheapest topic in every location ($4-$13 CPL). Best ad this year: the AI & robotics report video, $4.10 CPL in EMEA.
- **Retargeting** works at $13 CPL; the press-quote image is its best ad.
- **Europe and the Middle East** are cheap to reach: $8-$13 CPM vs $33-$44 in the US.

Going wrong

- **Too thin to learn**: about $4 a day per ad set, about 8 ads each, duplicates splitting the data.
- **Expensive pockets**: Health in the US $36-$51 CPL, Brand in California $140 for 1 lead. The healthcare video marked to pause still runs.
- **FR_Alibaba** (traffic, our internal team) took 41% of the last 30 days' spend: $3,845 for $0.03 clicks in Turkey, Greece and Eastern Europe. Ended 5 Oct.

CPL: last 30 days (14 Sep – 13 Oct 2026); CPM and best ads: this year. Live = delivering on 13 Oct. Account history: 83 campaigns, 272 ad sets, 1,785 ads.

Meta proposal: 4 campaigns, 7 ad sets, 3-5 ads each, same $160 a day

New goal: a corporate form sent (no student or job-seeker answers), then qualified leads from the CRM

4 CAMPAIGNS	7 AD SETS	21-35 ADS
Scale · EMEA & Middle East CBO · about $45 a day	**Deep Tech reports** **AI for enterprise**	**3-5 ads per ad set** One copy of each ad
Scale · US & Canada CBO · about $45 a day	**Deep Tech reports** **AI for enterprise**	**3-5 ads per ad set** One copy of each ad
Test ABO · about $30 a day (20%)	**New offer or creative** $15 a day **New offer or creative** $15 a day Read on day 7; winners move to Scale	**3-5 ads per ad set** Health, Brand and case studies go here first
Retargeting · worldwide About $40 a day	**Past sign-ups and visitors** strict audience	**3-5 ads** Press quotes, case studies

What changes

Campaigns	9	→ 4	Goal	any form	→ corporate form, then qualified
Ad sets	30	→ 7	Copies of one ad	up to 12+	→ 1
Ads	243	→ 21-35	Tests	none logged	→ 2 a month, read on day 7
Budget per ad set	about $4 a day	→ $15-$40 a day	Total budget	$160 a day	→ same; split by results, weekly

Scale = proven topics. Region budgets start equal and move weekly to the lower CPL.

Google Search today: 3 campaigns, 9 ad groups, 9 ads on $76 a day

Goal since 28 Sep: any lead form (qualified leads were taken out that day) · keywords: all broad match + AI Max

3 CAMPAIGNS	9 AD GROUPS	9 ADS	WHERE CLICKS LAND
US & Canada $34 a day · capped by budget 300 keywords	**Brand** 46% of spend **Startup collaboration** 45% **Innovation** 6% · 24% conv. rate **AI strategy** 3%	**4 ads** 1 per ad group	**Homepage 56%** Innovation platform 30% · Supply chain 5%
Europe & Middle East $37 a day · 6 countries	**Startup collaboration** 38% **Brand** 28% **Innovation** 23% **AI strategy** 12%	**4 ads** 1 per ad group	**Homepage 65%** Innovation platform 26%
Coworking · Silicon Valley $6 a day · since 2023	**Coworking** mostly brand and address searches	**1 ad**	**Coworking offer** Not part of the corporate goal

Going well

- **Corporate searches convert**: Innovation ad group (supply-chain page), 24% conversion rate, $12.86 each.
- **Corporate copy wins**: “Top Corporate Accelerator” ads converted 9–10% at half the generic ad's cost ($33–$40 vs $56–$81).
- **Europe & Middle East**: $46 per conversion; Saudi Arabia is the cheapest market ($36).

Going wrong

- **60% of spend lands on the homepage**, which has no form ($6,495).
- **37% of spend buys our own name**, in campaigns capped by budget.
- **Startup-side traffic**: “Startup collaboration” is 42% of spend; “Venture Capitalist” headline; coworking extras; “startup india certificate” ($186).
- **Unstable, broken basics**: goal changed twice in two weeks, budgets cut 71–76% in three days; name, logo and 14 of 18 images disapproved.

Shares of spend this year (1 Jan – 13 Oct 2026). Google bills in EUR, shown in USD at 1.1177.

Google proposal: brand apart, corporate only, a form behind every ad

New goal: a corporate form sent, then qualified leads (already set up as a conversion in Google)

4 CAMPAIGNS	8 AD GROUPS	16 ADS	LANDING PAGES
Brand · all markets Own small, capped budget	**"plug and play" searches** exact and phrase	**2 ads**	**Corporate page with a form**
Corporate · US & Canada Phrase and exact match + negatives	**Corporate innovation** **Startup scouting** **Industry topics** supply chain, health…	**2 ads each** corporate copy	**Own page with a form**
Corporate · Europe & Middle East Same set-up, 6 countries	**Corporate innovation** **Startup scouting** **Industry topics**	**2 ads each** corporate copy	**Own page with a form**
Coworking · Silicon Valley Review: keep separate or pause	Coworking	**2 ads**	**Coworking page**

What changes

Brand	37%, inside non-brand	→ own campaign, capped	Goal	any lead form	→ corporate form, then qualified
Startup collab.	42% of spend	→ corporate ad groups only	Assets	disapproved items	→ fixed; startup extras removed
Keywords	all broad + AI Max	→ phrase, exact + negatives	Changes	daily tweaks	→ one owner, weekly review
Landing	homepage 60%	→ a form behind every ad	Total budget	$76 a day	→ same, brand capped

Negatives: other accelerators, grants, investors, certificates. Industry topics follow our landing pages (supply chain, health).

CHATGPT ADS

ChatGPT Ads: Test 1 had nowhere to convert, Test 2 fixes that

TEST 1 · 23 SEP – 2 OCT · DONE

1 CAMPAIGN	1 AD GROUP	5 ADS	1 LANDING PAGE
Test 1 US only · $28 a day	**7 topics** corporate innovation, governments, accelerators, startup pilots	**5 ads** One got 74% of views; auto-rewrite was on	**Homepage** No form · no tracking links

$257	4,021	43	0
spent	ad views	clicks · 1.1% CTR	leads

TEST 2 · 10 DAYS · PROPOSED

1 CAMPAIGN	2 AD GROUPS	6 ADS	1 LANDING PAGE
Test 2: Startup Scouting US + Europe · same daily budget	**US** startup scouting topics **Europe** startup scouting topics	**3 ads per ad group** Our copy: auto-rewrite off	**Startup Scouting page** Short form · tracking links

Test 1 kept: the topics describe our buyers and the budget held. ChatGPT Ads bill in EUR, shown in USD at 1.1177.

Landing pages: Meta's work, Google and ChatGPT land on the homepage

CHANNEL	WHERE THE CLICKS LAND	VERDICT
Meta Prospecting and retargeting	**Report pages** AI & robotics, quantum, Spain grid, AI trend… ; **Innovation platform page** retargeting	**Form next to the headline** Asks company size and job level; within one phone screen
Google Search US & Canada, Europe & Middle East	**Homepage** 60% of spend ; **Innovation platform page** 28% ; **Supply chain page** 5% (US)	**No form / one page for everyone** Platform page: form 2 screens down on phone, no company-size question
ChatGPT Ads Test 1	**Homepage** 100%	**No form, no tracking**

Also wrong on the forms

- Report forms offer “student” and “looking for a job”, and those count as Meta leads.
- Case studies (Mitsubishi Electric, Aeroporti di Roma) sit behind a 10-field form.

Proposal: 3 page types, one short form

1. **Corporate innovation** page for Google brand and corporate ad groups.
2. **Startup Scouting** page for Google and ChatGPT Test 2.
3. **Report pages** for Meta: keep. Every paid form asks company size and role; no student or job-seeker option.

Shares of Google Search spend this year, US & Canada and Europe & Middle East campaigns together.

NEXT STEPS

Next steps and what we need from you

Now, before 30 Oct

1. **Handover from the agency**: access, change log, audiences, creatives.
2. **Pause** Health (US), Brand (California), the healthcare video and the 2025 report ad (0 leads).
3. **Clean Google**: negatives, remove startup and coworking extras, fix name, logo, images.

Next 30 days

4. **Meta**: move to 4 campaigns, 7 ad sets.
5. **Google**: brand campaign, corporate ad groups, a form behind every ad.
6. **Goals**: corporate forms on both; start the CRM link for qualified leads.

Next 60 days

7. **Two pages**: corporate innovation and Startup Scouting, short form.
8. **ChatGPT Test 2**: 10 days, US and Europe.
9. **Test plan**: 2 Meta tests a month, read on day 7.

We need from you

A. **Agree on success**: qualified corporate and government leads, even if lead volume drops and CPL rises at first.

B. **Web team time** in November for the two pages and the form changes.

C. **One owner** for ad-account changes from 1 Nov: Felipe, every change logged.